

PREMIUM

Pre-Departure Checklist

From visa confirmed to your residence permit application

2-4 weeks before departure

- Confirm your visa sticker's validity and entry conditions
- Check your passport's remaining validity against your programme dates
- Confirm your Zulassungsbescheid's start date against your planned arrival
- Arrange accommodation - many universities offer student housing with its own application deadline and often long waiting lists
- Confirm your health insurance will be active from your arrival date

The week before

- Save or print: passport photo page, visa, Zulassungsbescheid, and proof of your accommodation
- Share your itinerary and emergency contacts with someone at home

Day of travel

- Arrive at the airport with sufficient buffer time
- Keep your passport, Zulassungsbescheid, and Sperrkonto confirmation in your hand luggage - not checked baggage

After you arrive: the mandatory follow-up steps

Your entry visa alone doesn't authorise your full stay - two further steps are required, both with real deadlines:

- Anmeldung: register your address at your local citizens' registration office (Bürgeramt/Einwohnermeldeamt) within the timeframe required in your city - this is a prerequisite for almost everything else, including opening a full bank account and getting your residence permit
- Aufenthaltserlaubnis: apply for your residence permit at your local Ausländerbehörde before your entry visa expires - this is what actually authorises your stay for the duration of your studies
- Enrol formally (Immatrikulation) at your university
- Access your Sperrkonto's monthly instalment once in Germany, if that's your financial mechanism
- Check your specific permitted working days before taking any part-time work